

## Chapter Two GETTING STARTED

# 2

### ***Read This Before Doing Anything!***

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#### ***If You Don't Have A Hard Drive***

If you don't have a hard drive, we heartily suggest making the investment. While System 6 will run fine on 3.5-only systems, you may end up with longer waits and, if you have only a single 3.5 drive, more disk swapping than with previous versions of the IIGS System Software. A good, fast hard drive is the single most significant improvement you can make to your computer because it allows you to store not only your System Software but all your programs and data on a single high-speed storage device. Don't take our word for it—ask anyone who already uses a hard drive on their IIGS. If you don't have the funds for a hard drive, an additional 3.5 drive or more memory can provide many of the same benefits at a lower cost.

If you decide not to get a hard drive, you won't really “install” System 6. You'll just start up the computer from the System 6 System Disk, just as you started up the System 5 (or earlier) System Disk when you wanted to use that System version. You may find that the additional features of System 6 are worth the occasional disk swap and choose to run under System 6 all the time, or you may decide to use System 6 only when you need its special features and start up directly into other programs via whatever System Software they came with. It's your choice.

If you have more than two megabytes of memory installed in your Apple IIGS, you may want to reserve some of your memory for use as a RAM Disk and install System 6 on the RAM Disk. See the FlashBoot manual for more information on using your IIGS RAM Disk and our exclusive FlashBoot utility.

#### **Note!**

Be sure to back up your System 6 disks before using them. See the section after the next one for instructions on using the ZZCopy program.

The System Disk included with the System 6 package is a *minimum* configuration. It's adequate for running most programs, but a few programs may require additional tools, fonts, or drivers to be installed. The System Disk has a little free space on it, so you can make another backup of the original System Disk, install the additional software on it, and use that as a special-purpose System 6 startup disk for a particular program. For more details on the Installer, see the hard drive installation section in this chapter.